

Luis Jose Aguirre-Lopez

PHD CANDIDATE

Chapel Hill, North Carolina

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Education

University of North Carolina

PHD BIOLOGY

- Advisor: Dr. Xiao Feng

Chapel Hill, North Carolina (USA)

2024 - present

Florida State University

PHD GEOGRAPHY

- Advisor: Dr. Xiao Feng

Tallahassee, Florida (USA)

2021 - 2023 (transferred out)

UNAM

MS BIOLOGICAL SCIENCES

- Advisor: Dr. Tania Escalante

Mexico City (Mexico)

2017 - 2020

University of Oviedo

BS BIOLOGY

- Undergraduate research advisor: Dr. Tomas Emilio Diaz

Asturias (Spain)

2010 - 2016

Awards, Fellowships & Grants

2026	Nominated to the Tanner Award for Excellence in Undergraduate Teaching , UNC	
2026-2027	Kenan Galapagos Fellowship , Center for Galapagos Studies	\$50000
2026	IALE-NA Student Travel Award , International Association for Landscape Ecology (IALE-North America)	\$1000
2022	UROP mentor grant , Center for Undergraduate Research and Academic Engagement, FSU	\$ 250
2020	Honorific mention for MS thesis , UNAM	
2017-2019	CONACYT scholarship , Mexican Government	\$14,500
2016	Santander Iberoamerica scholarship , Santander Bank - University of Oviedo	\$3,250
2014	Santander CRUE-CEPYME internship , Santander Bank - University of Oviedo	\$2,000
2012-2013	ERASMUS scholarship , European Union - University of Oviedo	\$3,250

Professional Experience

2026-now	Kenan Galapagos Fellow , Department of Biology and Center for Galapagos Studies, UNC
2024-2026	Graduate Teaching/Research Assistant , Department of Biology, UNC
2022-2023	Instructor of Record , Department of Geography, FSU
2021-2023	Graduate Teaching/Research Assistant , Department of Geography, FSU
2017-2019	Fieldwork Coordinator , Conservation Biogeography Lab, UNAM
2014	Internships in an environmental consulting , Taxus S. L.
2014	Internships in a zoo and species recovery center , Faunastur S. L.

Publications

IN PROGRESS

Aguirre-Lopez, L. J., Feng, X. (in progress). Testing the deviation from the power-law nature of ecological networks across environmental gradients.

Aguirre-Lopez, L. J., Ascanio, A., Feng, X. (in progress). Distinguishing fundamental and realized biotic interactions: Implications for the Eltonian shortfall and ecological research.

PUBLISHED

Chen, X., **Aguirre-Lopez, L. J.**, and Feng, X. (2026). Human Impacts, Climate, and Trait-Mediated Responses in Contemporary Mammal Distributions. **Journal of Biogeography** 53(8), e70322. <https://doi.org/10.1111/jbi.70322>

Aguirre-Lopez, L. J., Hurlbert, Allen H., and Feng, X. (2026). The Multifaceted Effects of Anthropogenic and Climatic Factors on Ecological Networks. **Global Ecology and Biogeography** 35(5), e70246. <https://doi.org/10.1111/geb.70246>

Xie, Y., Park, D.S., Sinnott-Armstrong, M.A., Ho, J., Chen, T., Weakley, A.S., **Aguirre-Lopez, L. J.**, Choi, J., Laitinen, M.M., Steeves, N.A., Huang, C.H., Xu, R., Feng, X. (2025). Using large language models to address the bottleneck of georeferencing natural history collections. **Nature Plants** 11, 2446–2450. <https://doi.org/10.1038/s41477-025-02162-y>.

Feng, X., Peterson, A. T., **Aguirre-Lopez, L. J.**, Burger, J., Chen, X., Papeş, M. (2024). Rethinking ecological niches and geographic distributions in face of pervasive human influence in the Anthropocene. **Biological Reviews** 99, 1481–1503. <https://doi.org/10.1111/brv.13077>.

Aguirre-Lopez, L. J., and Escalante, T. (2021). Use of distribution models in the conservation of a Mexican endemic lagomorph. **THERYA** 12(3), 571–582. DOI:10.12933/therya-21-1088

SCIENTIFIC DISSEMINATION

Aguirre-Lopez, L. J., Espiritu-Guerrero, P. C., and Escalante, T. (2021). Conejo entre volcanes. ¿Cómo ves?, 273, 28–31.

Aguirre-Lopez, L. J., Espiritu-Guerrero, P. C., and Escalante, T. (2021). La transición entre dos reinos: el hogar del zacatuche. Elementos 124, 65–69.

BOOK CHAPTERS

Aguirre-Lopez, L. J. (2024) Species Distribution Models; Ecological Niche; and Factors linked to biodiversity: Environmental heterogeneity, in Escalante, T.; Morrone J. J.; and García-Trejo E. 2024. Biogeografía Práctica. ISBN: 978-607-30-9190-9

GOVERNMENT REPORT

SEMARNAT (2021). Program of Action for Conservation of Zacatuche (*Romerolagus diazi*), SEMARNAT/CONANP, Mexico.

Presentations

CONTRIBUTED PRESENTATIONS

Aguirre-Lopez, L.J., Feng, X. 2026. Oral presentation: Testing the power-law nature of ecological networks across the anthropogenic landscape. Annual meeting of the International Association for Landscape Ecology-North America at Athens (GA), USA.

Aguirre-Lopez, L.J., Feng, X. 2025. Oral presentation: Ecological Networks Across the Anthropogenic Landscape. Annual meeting of the International Association for Landscape Ecology-North America at Raleigh (NC), USA.

Carina Edwards and Ayyan Hussain (undergraduate students), **Aguirre-Lopez, L.J.**. 2022. Use of very high resolution satellite imagery for sampling *Carnegiea gigantea* (Magnoliopsida: *Cactaceae*). Poster presented by mentored undergraduates: Undergraduate Research Symposium 2022 at Tallahassee, Florida.

Aguirre-Lopez, L.J., Escalante, T. 2019. Oral presentation: Conservation priorities for *Romerolagus diazi* based on species distribution models including biotic interactions. A talk that I gave at the IBS 2019 Humboldt Meeting & 2nd Latin American Biogeography Meeting at Quito, Ecuador.

Aguirre-Lopez, L.J., Espiritu-Guerrero, P.C., Escalante, T. 2018. Poster: Studies of the ecology and geographical distribution of mammals in the Iztaccihuatl-Popocatepetl National Park at State of Mexico, Mexico. A poster that I presented with Espiritu-Guerrero, P.C.

Photo-trapping contest & lab students advising invited by Escalante, T., at the XIV National Congress of Mammalogy at Merida, Mexico

Teaching Experience

2026	Evolution of Extraordinary Adaptations , Teaching Assistant	UNC at CH
2024 - 2026	Biology Research Skills , Teaching Assistant	UNC at CH
2024	How Cells Function , Teaching Assistant	UNC at CH
2023	Environmental Science , Teaching Assistant	FSU
2022, 2023	World Geography , Instructor of Record	FSU
2022, 2023	Practicum in Field Environmental Biology (Summer) , Teaching Assistant	Notre Dame
2023	Physical Geography , Teaching Assistant	FSU
2022	Landscape Ecology , Instructor of Record	FSU

Mentoring

2026	Nosa Osawe , PhD student, UNC (Department of Biology)	Chapel Hill
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Professional Development

SERVICE

Co-organizer of symposium:

Biodiversity in the anthropogenic landscapes: Patterns, Drivers, and Implications for conservation, IALE-North America
2025: organization and moderator for one session

PEER REVIEW

Biodiversity Informatics, BMC Plant Biology, Physical Geography, Fisheries Oceanography

DEVELOPMENT

Introduction to Julia (2024), online, (2 hours)

Preventing Harassment and Discrimination for Non-Supervisors (2024), online, (1 hour)

Data Carpentry Workshop: Genomics (2021), online, data management and analysis for genomics research (16 hours)

Wallace, a modular software for monitoring species distributions (2019), tour of the workflow and extending functionality with custom R functions, at Quito, Ecuador (4 hours)

Photo-trapping R (2017), organization and analysis of photos from camera traps in R, at BUAP in Puebla, Mexico (30 hours)

PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIPS

International Association for Landscape Ecology (2025)

Asociación Mexicana de Mastozoología A. C. (AMMAC) (2022)